

Report: Service Accounts & Security

1. Introduction

Service accounts were identified and reviewed using PowerShell on the domain controller. The accounts were checked for the presence of Service Principal Names (SPNs), and password expiration settings were verified. The krbtgt account was the only account found with an SPN. This task did not involve any creation or movement of service accounts, and no user was moved into the ServiceAccounts OU. The findings were documented based on the command outputs from the domain controller.

2. Objective

The objective was to identify all user accounts in Active Directory that have configured Service Principal Names (SPNs), check if those accounts have password expiration disabled, and document what services or applications are using those accounts. The entire process was performed using PowerShell commands and confirmed on the domain controller.

3. Tools used

- Windows Server (AD DS)
- Windows PowerShell
- Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC)

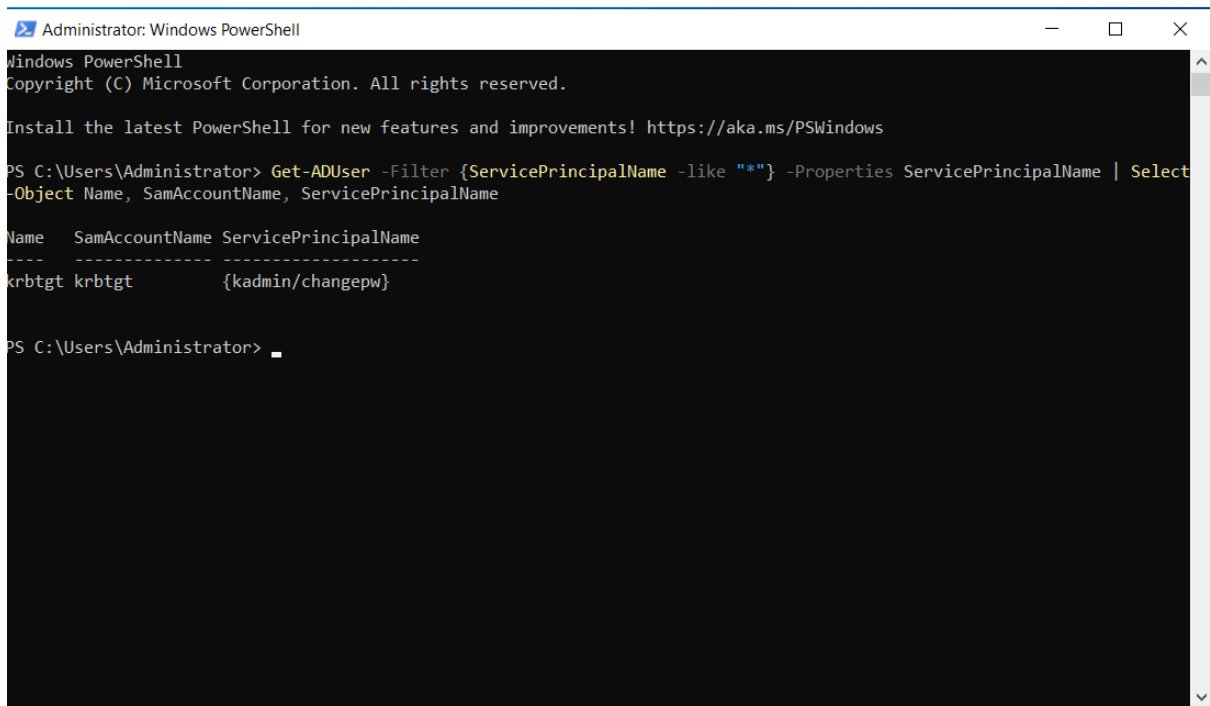
4. Methodology

4.1 Identify All Service Accounts

The following command was used in PowerShell to identify accounts with SPNs:

Get-ADUser -Filter {ServicePrincipalName -like "*"} -Properties ServicePrincipalName | Select-Object Name, SamAccountName, ServicePrincipalName

The command returned only one account: krbtgt, with the Service Principal Name kadmin/changepw. No other accounts were listed in the output.



```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
Windows PowerShell
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PS C:\Users\Administrator> Get-ADUser -Filter {ServicePrincipalName -like "*"} -Properties ServicePrincipalName | Select-Object Name, SamAccountName, ServicePrincipalName

Name      SamAccountName ServicePrincipalName
-----
krbtgt    krbtgt          {kadmin/changepw}
```

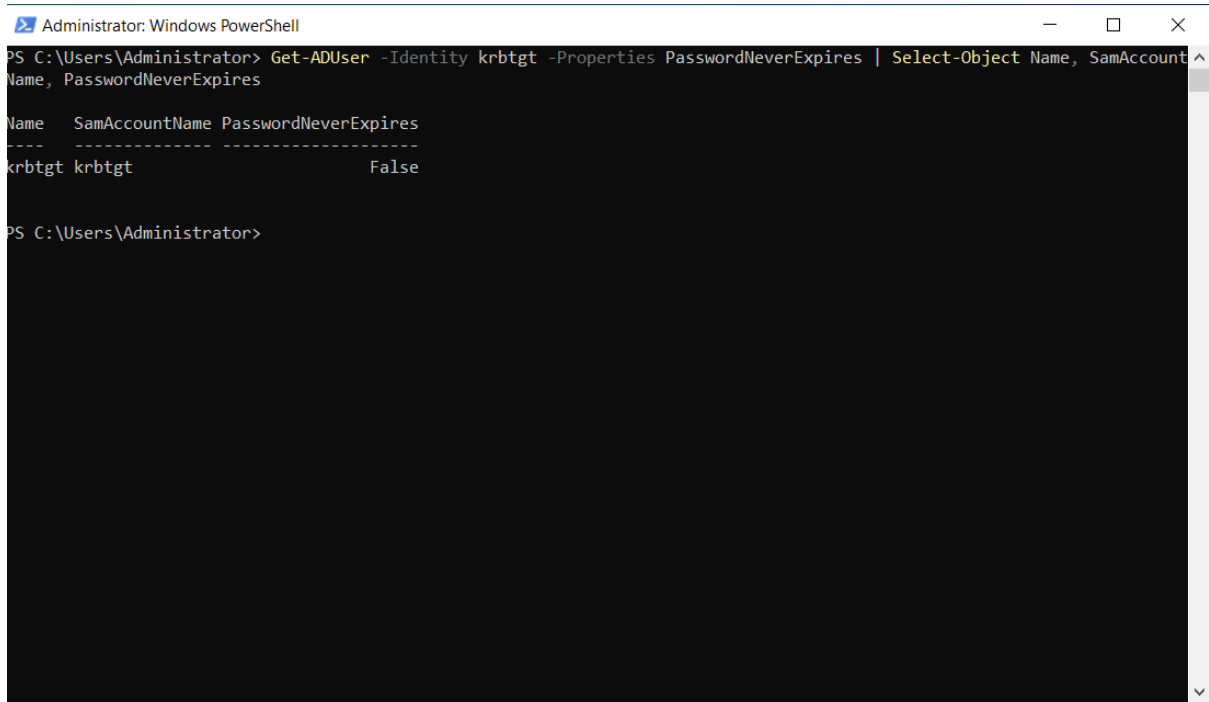
(krbtgt account has a Service Principal Name (kadmin/changepw), meaning it's functioning as a service account.)

4.2 Check if Service Accounts Have Password Expiration Disabled

The following command was run in PowerShell to check whether the krbtgt account had the PasswordNeverExpires flag enabled:

Get-ADUser -Identity krbtgt -Properties PasswordNeverExpires | Select-Object Name, SamAccountName, PasswordNeverExpires

The output showed that PasswordNeverExpires was set to False for the krbtgt account. This means the password expiration setting is not disabled.



```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\Users\Administrator> Get-ADUser -Identity krbtgt -Properties PasswordNeverExpires | Select-Object Name, SamAccountName, PasswordNeverExpires
Name      SamAccountName PasswordNeverExpires
-----
krbtgt    krbtgt          False

PS C:\Users\Administrator>
```

(PasswordNeverExpires = False for the krbtgt account.)

4.3 Document Which Services/Apps Use These Accounts

Only one account was found with an SPN, which was the krbtgt account. It had the SPN kadmin/changepw. No other SPNs were identified. No service account was found linked to any manually configured service or application. No entries were added to the ServiceAccounts OU.

5. Recommendations

- Run regular PowerShell queries to identify all accounts with SPNs configured.
- Verify password expiration settings on each identified account using PowerShell.
- Maintain a list of all accounts that function as service accounts, even if only one is currently detected.

- Reserve the ServiceAccounts OU for any accounts added manually for application or service use.
- Document each service account's purpose and SPN when additional accounts are configured in the future.

6. Conclusion

PowerShell was used to identify service accounts by searching for configured Service Principal Names. Only the krbtgt account was returned with a valid SPN. The password expiration status for the krbtgt account was checked, and it was confirmed that the setting was not disabled. No other accounts were returned with SPNs. No service-specific accounts were detected, and no changes were made to the ServiceAccounts OU. The output was verified directly from the domain controller.